

INDEPENDENT CONTRACTOR AGREEMENT

This Independent Contractor Agreement (the "Agreement") is made effective as of 19 June 2024, by and between Meridian Health Solutions ("Client") and Elena Rostova ("Contractor").

1. **SERVICES PROVIDED.** Client hereby engages Contractor to provide consulting and advisory services related to strategic business development (the "Services"). Contractor agrees to perform these Services in a professional and diligent manner, adhering to industry standards.

2. **COMPENSATION.** In consideration for the Services, Client shall pay Contractor a flat fee of \$44,000.00. Payments shall be made in monthly installments upon receipt of an itemized invoice. Contractor shall be responsible for all out-of-pocket expenses incurred unless otherwise approved in advance by Client.

3. **INDEPENDENT CONTRACTOR STATUS.** It is expressly understood that Contractor is an independent contractor and not an employee, agent, or partner of Client. Contractor is solely responsible for all taxes, withholdings, and insurance associated with the compensation received under this Agreement. Contractor is not entitled to any employee benefits provided by Client.

4. **INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY.** Any work product, reports, or materials developed by Contractor in connection with the Services shall be the exclusive property of Client. Contractor hereby assigns all rights, title, and interest in such work product to Client without further compensation.

5. **CONFIDENTIALITY.** Contractor agrees to hold all proprietary information of Client in strict confidence and not to disclose such information to any third party. This obligation shall survive the termination of this Agreement.

6. **TERM AND TERMINATION.** This Agreement shall commence on 19 June 2024 and continue until the Services are completed. Either party may terminate this Agreement with thirty (30) days' prior written notice. Upon termination, Client shall pay Contractor for all Services satisfactorily performed up to the date of termination.

7. **GOVERNING LAW.** This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the State of Washington.